PROCESS DOCUMENT

The Collected

Art happens in different forms. I am interested in changing forms. I am interested in machine learning.

GOLDSMITHS TEXTILE COLLECTION

RUSSELL-COTES COLLECTION

CEMETERY DATASET, PHOTOGRAPHED

OVERVIEW

Four stages

The project moves through four states. Each one changes what the work is made of, and each one is a consequence of the last.

01

Collect

Three archives become training data.

02

Fuse

Two of them are merged at the level of weights.

03

Embody

The output leaves the image plane as material.

04

Release

The object is given a world and learns to move.

STAGE ONE

Collect

The Goldsmiths Textile Collection — 1,400 images — is trained as a DreamBooth LoRA. The archive becomes a texture: yarn, thread, weave. Thirty-six photographs of the Russell-Cotes Collection are used as conditioning through an IP-Adapter. That archive becomes a structure.

The first outputs are thirty-six images in which Russell-Cotes rooms are rebuilt entirely out of Goldsmiths thread. The model had to be forced out of photography and into cloth: overdriven LoRA weights, a raised guidance scale, a coarse scheduler, and prompts that ban photographic language.

A third archive runs alongside these two: my own photographs taken in cemeteries, trained with a WGAN. It stays separate from the museum collections and becomes the moving image.

STAGE TWO

Fuse

Imitation is then removed. Photographs and woven generations are paired into a dataset, joined by a single instruction: *transform this scene into a heavy Goldsmiths textile tapestry*. This trains a model that learns the transformation itself, and the LoRA weights are then merged into it.

> *After the merge, neither collection is copying the other. There is one model that can no longer tell them apart.*

STAGE THREE

Embody

The fused output is pushed out of the image plane and into material.

Two dimensions	Heatpress sublimation on latex; UV print on leather; UV print on recycled PLA panels.
Three dimensions	Generated image transformed into a 3D mesh and printed in clear resin.

Each output is a different state of the same fused model: the image becomes a surface, then a printed skin, then a solid object that can be walked around.

STAGE FOUR

Release

The sculpture stops being an object and becomes an agent.

- Trained inside a car-racing world model — it learns to move.
- Placed in a custom real-time environment — it is given somewhere to be.
- Sound generated by converting a still from the video into audio.
- Prompted into scenes with the rest of its collection: swimming, struggling, holding calm discussions.

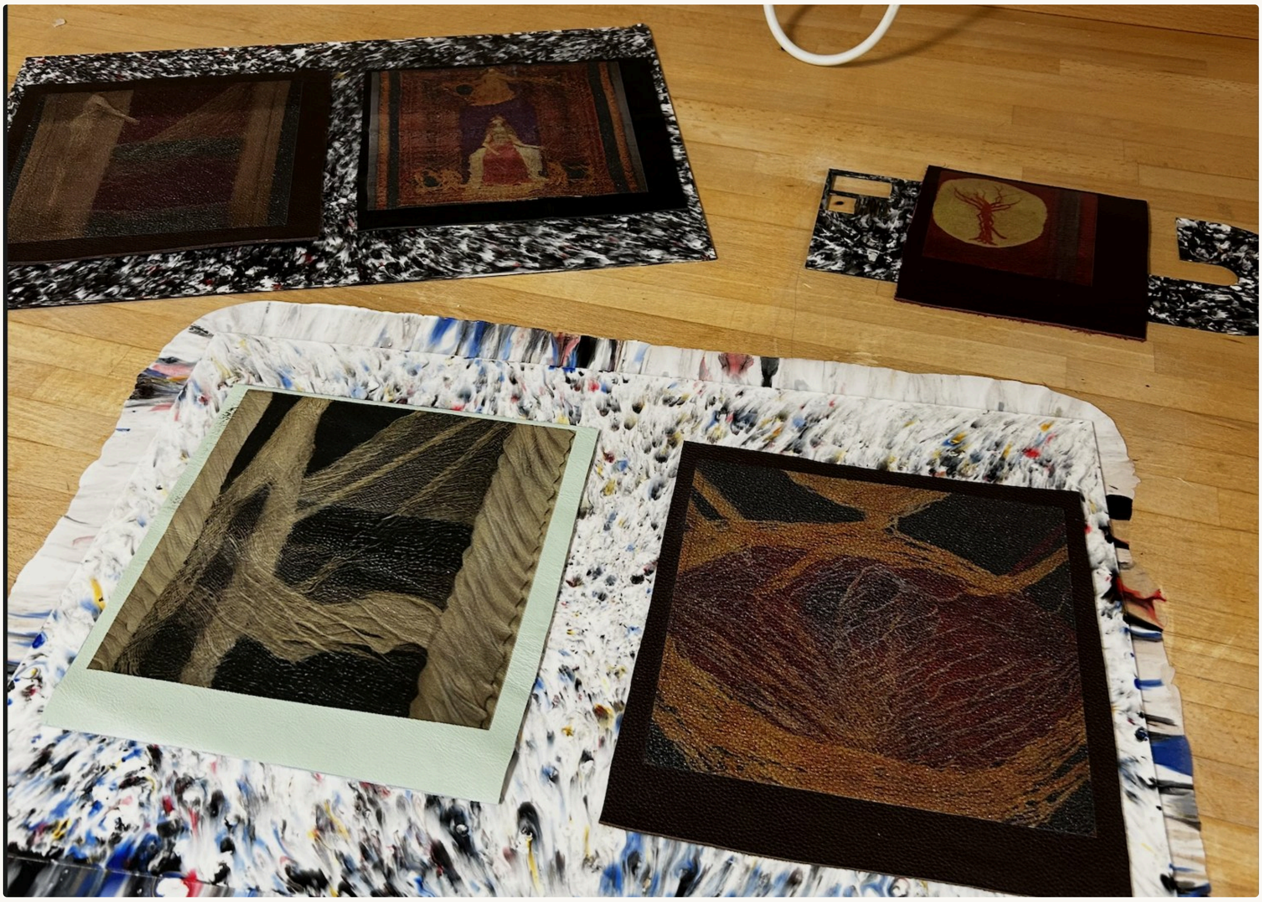
MOVING IMAGE

Cemeteries as museums

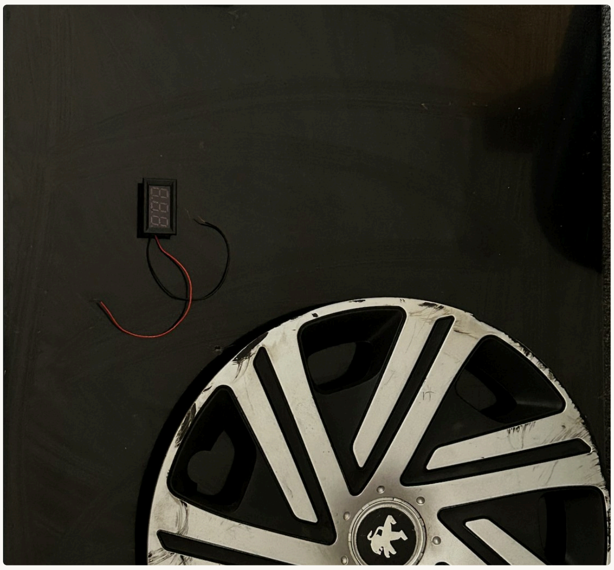
Cemeteries are museums that hold humans as datasets. The video is generated from my own cemetery photographs, trained with a WGAN: gravestones exchange places as though playing chess, the ground shakes with their movement, and stone figures come to life and walk.

Merging collections full of dead figures is a way of learning their stories, techniques, fictions and histories — the same operation the model performs on the archives.

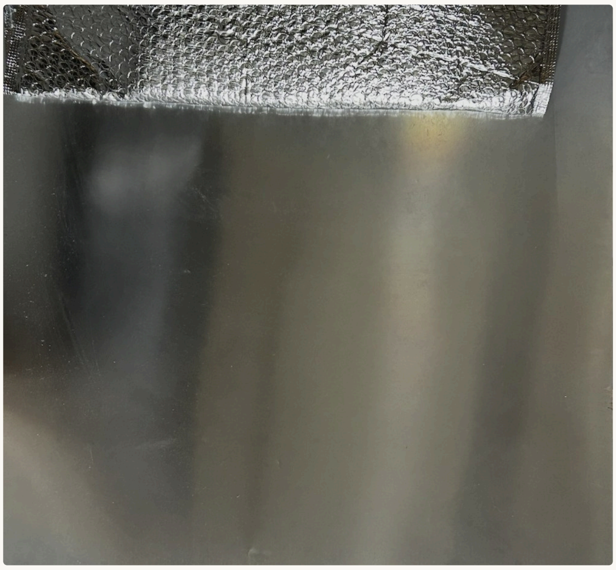
Material states



UV PRINTS ON LEATHER, MOUNTED ON RECYCLED PLA PANELS



STUDIO SURFACE, SALVAGED COMPONENTS



REFLECTIVE SHEET, SCREEN MATERIAL

PRESENTATION

Installation

Shown in a church, in daylight. Dead screens on the ground, reconstituted waste on the wall, one generated body among them.

Floor

Two flat surfaces salvaged from inside a television, one aluminium-like and one a broken screen. The display is dismantled and laid horizontal.

Wall

Selected UV prints on colourful recycled PLA panels. The substrate is itself remelted failed material.

Centre

The 3D printed sculpture, scaled up from the work-in-progress piece.

Sound

Delivered through headphones, generated from a still of the video.

The church setting gives the work the frame it argues for: a building that already holds the dead as a collection. In daylight the screen surfaces on the floor read as objects before they read as displays, and the clear resin takes the light directly. The visitor walks in on a collection that has already rearranged itself.

TOOLS

Software and materials

Image models	Stable Diffusion 1.5, U-Net, DreamBooth LoRA, IP-Adapter, InstructPix2Pix, WGAN
Training	Python and PyCharm, Hugging Face training scripts, custom batch and weight-merging scripts
Moving image	ComfyUI for video generation; image-to-audio conversion for sound
Simulation	MuJoCo world model, three.js environment, TouchDesigner visuals
Fabrication	Resin 3D printing, dye-sublimation heatpress, UV flatbed printing
Materials	Clear resin, recycled PLA panels, latex, leather, salvaged screen surfaces
Display	Screen, headphones, wall and floor space

All models trained and merged locally; no pre-built generative service was used.

POSITION

The not-founder

I am the not-founder of this project. The work is not asked to carry my ideology; it stands on its own creation and its algorithmic behaviour. The merged model is the author, and I am its condition.

Art happens in different forms. I am interested in changing forms.

When I woke up for you today, I arrived at yesterday. Dreaming in collections, forgetting who I am.

Zylinska argues that AI dreams up the human outside the human, disturbing the older idea of the artist as a system that processed just enough data for meaning to emerge. This project puts that pressure into material: a collection that keeps changing state, and an object that eventually moves on its own.

Zylinska, J., 2020. AI Art: *Machine Visions and Warped Dreams*. London: Open Humanities Press.